almost every day for the next few days. On one such day, when we were on our way to the briefing room, I saw Dada at the tarmac. Dada, dressed in his camouflage uniform, saw me at the same time. We both ran towards each other. He was shocked to see me at Kargil.

'Why are you here?' he said after he hugged me.

'I'm in Srinagar and will be flying in this area,' I replied. 'How are you, Dada?'

'I'm fine,' he said, 'but why do you have to fly in this area?'

'Why? Why should I not fly here?'

'It's not safe here,' a concerned Dada said.

'Then why are you here?' I asked. But Dada had no answer.

'It's okay, Dada, we both serve the nation,' I said, and he hugged me once more. I had met Dada after a long time. Until then, I was not aware of his deployment in the combat zone. I didn't want him to see I was worried about him. We went to the briefing room and Dada took me to have breakfast with him in his unit's temporary mess after the briefing was over. After knowing that Dada would also be coming to the same briefing room every day, we started meeting each other at the tarmac and having breakfast together over the next few days. He would tell me about the progress of the army's operations, which came at the cost of officers and men, and I would tell him about the Air Force's involvement. I remember celebrating one morning when he told me that the Indian Army had successfully captured Tololing in Dras sector. It was a tough war, but India was slowly inching towards victory.